PORT·BRIEF
Freight intelligence for UK forwarders, importers & logistics managers

Wednesday 30 September 2026
Forecast run 2026-09-30 16:21 UTC

Calm week at UK and North European ports: a good window to clear releases

No weather disruption is forecast at any of the eight ports we track, so push releases and deliveries through now. On the way in, Atlantic arrivals into the Channel may run up to 1 day late. August reliability: Sea-Intelligence 49.9%, Xeneta 29%.

PORTS NEEDING ACTION	INBOUND DELAY RISK	RELIABILITY · SEA-INTELLIGENCE	RELIABILITY · XENETA
0 / 8	**2**	**49.9%**	**29%**
UK & North European gateways	lanes, worst: Western Approaches	Aug 2026 · -5.9 pp m/m	Aug 2026 · -4.0 pp m/m

Congestion data is not connected for this issue: port statuses reflect weather forecasts and port news only.

PORT STATUS · WHAT TO DO THIS WEEK

UK gateways

Felixstowe — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. Speak to your carrier about release and delivery now and book haulage slots while the weather holds.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Southampton — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. A good week to clear releases: confirm delivery dates with your carrier and haulier now.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

London Gateway — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. Speak to your carrier about release now and lock in weekend haulage while slots are easy to get.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Liverpool — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. Speak to your carrier about release and delivery now.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

North European hubs

Rotterdam — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. If you tranship via Rotterdam, confirm your feeder connection now while conditions are settled.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Antwerp — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. Speak to your carrier about release and onward delivery now.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Bremerhaven — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

No crane or pilotage limits forecast all week. Speak to your carrier about release and feeder connections now.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Hamburg — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

Monday's wind risk has eased in the latest forecast, and no limits are now expected. Speak to your carrier about release now.

Congestion data unavailable · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

● Running normally ▲ Watch ■ Congested ◆ Disruption likely · Weather windows in UK time. Congestion vs normal: Sinay berth occupancy compared with that port's usual level.

PORTS · SIX-DAY WEATHER OUTLOOK

Crane and pilotage conditions

A quiet week on the quayside. No port we track is forecast to reach crane or pilotage limits in the next six days. Hamburg's Monday wind risk from this morning's run has faded, with peak gusts revised down from 15.2 m/s to 11.9 m/s. Congestion figures are not yet connected, so each status reflects weather and port news only.

PORT	WED 30	THU 01	FRI 02	SAT 03	SUN 04	MON 05	TUE 06	OCCUPANCY
Felixstowe	8 · 0.7	10 · 0.4	8 · 0.4	7 · 0.4	6 · 0.4	8 · 0.3	10 · 0.3	n/a
Southampton	11 · 0.9	10 · 0.9	8 · 0.6	6 · 0.3	7 · 0.3	8 · 0.3	13 · 0.3	n/a
London Gateway	9 · 0.4	10 · 0.3	10 · 0.3	8 · 0.2	8 · 0.3	9 · 0.3	12 · 0.3	n/a
Liverpool	7 · 0.6	12 · 0.7	14 · 1.0	8 · 1.0	8 · 1.1	11 · 0.8	12 · 1.0	n/a
Rotterdam	9 · 0.5	11 · 0.6	6 · 0.4	6 · 0.3	9 · 0.8	9 · 0.8	11 · 0.7	n/a
Antwerp	10 · 0.5	11 · 0.6	8 · 0.5	5 · 0.2	6 · 0.6	7 · 0.7	10 · 0.6	n/a
Bremerhaven	9 · 0.6	9 · 0.6	7 · 0.3	7 · 0.6	9 · 1.4	10 · 1.4	11 · 1.3	n/a
Hamburg	9 · 0.7	9 · 0.7	6 · 0.3	8 · 0.9	11 · 1.7	12 · 1.7	12 · 1.5	n/a

Cells: peak gust m/s · peak sea m (UTC days). ▲ Watch ◆ Likely — crane stoppages from gusts ≥ 15 / 20 m/s; pilot boarding from sea ≥ 2.5 / 3.5 m or long-period swell. Occupancy: Sinay berth occupancy (gap vs port's usual level, pp).

ON THE WAY IN · LANES & CHOKEPOINTS

Weather that could delay your arrivals

Two lanes may slow arrivals. Seas of 4.9 m in the Western Approaches on Thursday could push transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel up to 1 day late. Off the Cape, 4 m seas on Tuesday 6 October may add up to 1 day to Asia–North Europe services routed that way. Don't book haulage against the published ETA; confirm the revised ETA with your carrier.

RISK	LANE	AFFECTS	WHEN	EXPECTED DELAY
▲ WATCH	Western Approaches	transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel	Thu 1 Oct	**up to 1 day**
▲ WATCH	Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas	Asia–North Europe services routed via the Cape	Tue 6 Oct	**up to 1 day**

Only two lanes reach watch level, both for sea state rather than wind, and neither is expected to last more than a day.

LANE	WED 30	THU 01	FRI 02	SAT 03	SUN 04	MON 05	TUE 06
Dover Strait	0.8 · 6	0.9 · 9	0.7 · 7	0.3 · 5	0.6 · 6	0.5 · 7	0.4 · 7
Western Approaches	3.9 · 10	▲ 4.9 · 10	3.8 · 9	2.3 · 5	1.5 · 3	1.3 · 6	1.8 · 6
Bay of Biscay	3.6 · 12	3.9 · 10	3.6 · 8	2.4 · 9	1.8 · 10	1.5 · 10	1.3 · 7
German Bight	0.8 · 8	0.8 · 10	0.4 · 6	1.0 · 7	1.8 · 9	1.8 · 9	1.6 · 9
Strait of Gibraltar	0.9 · 2	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 9	1.0 · 8	1.0 · 9	1.0 · 5	0.8 · 3
Mid-North Atlantic	3.8 · 13	3.6 · 12	2.8 · 8	2.3 · 6	1.5 · 8	1.4 · 5	1.7 · 9
Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas	3.4 · 13	3.3 · 11	2.5 · 11	2.6 · 10	2.7 · 13	2.7 · 9	▲ 4.0 · 14
Suez approaches (Port Said)	1.0 · 7	0.8 · 6	0.6 · 8	0.5 · 6	0.5 · 4	0.4 · 6	0.4 · 4

Bab-el-Mandeb / Gulf of Aden	0.8 · 9	0.8 · 7	0.9 · 9	1.2 · 9	1.3 · 10	1.1 · 9	1.1 · 9
Arabian Sea	1.1 · 1	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 5	1.0 · 4	0.9 · 3	0.9 · 2
South of Sri Lanka	1.6 · 7	1.7 · 6	1.6 · 4	1.5 · 4	1.4 · 4	1.3 · 3	1.3 · 2
Strait of Malacca	0.2 · 5	0.1 · 5	0.1 · 4	0.1 · 4	0.1 · 6	0.0 · 4	0.1 · 3
Taiwan Strait	0.3 · 3	0.4 · 8	1.6 · 12	1.4 · 10	0.9 · 8	3.2 · 16	3.2 · 15
Panama approaches (Colón)	1.0 · 4	1.0 · 6	0.9 · 4	0.8 · 6	0.7 · 5	0.7 · 5	0.6 · 4

Cells: peak sea m · peak wind m/s. ▲ Watch (sea ≥ 4 m or gale) ◆ Likely (sea ≥ 6 m or severe gale). Agulhas also flags south-west swell against the current.

Forecast drift since the last run

WHERE	DAY	GUST	SEA
Hamburg	Mon 5 Oct	15→12	1.7→1.7

Tropical cyclones

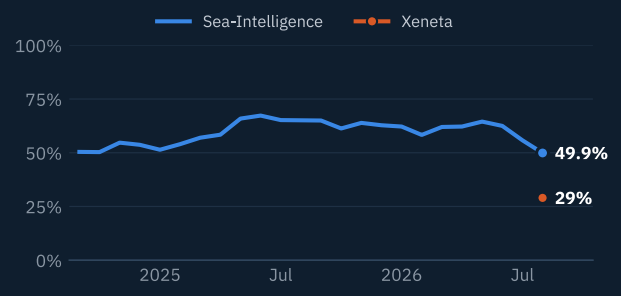
STORM	STRENGTH	NEAREST TRACKED
NOLO-26	Tropical Storm	none within 1,200 km
RACHEL-26	Hurricane/Typhoon > 74 mph	none within 1,200 km
HANNA-26	Tropical Depression	none within 1,200 km
NINETEEN-E-26	Tropical Depression	none within 1,200 km
TWENTYSIX-26	Tropical Storm	none within 1,200 km

SCHEDULE RELIABILITY · MONTHLY, ~4–6 WEEKS LAGGED

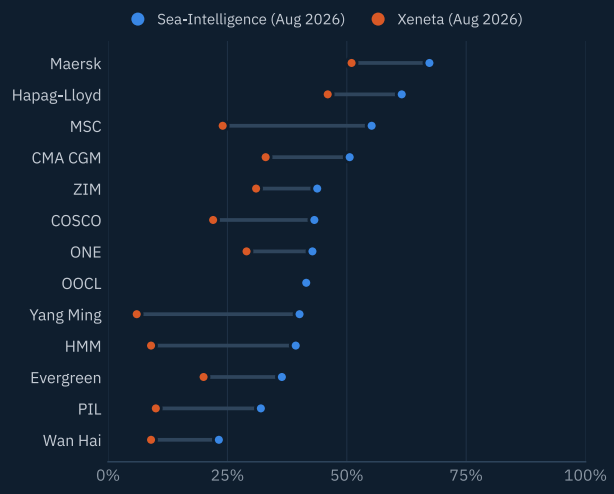
Two benchmarks, two definitions of on time

Sea-Intelligence puts August global schedule reliability at 49.9%, down 5.9 pp on July and 15.2 pp on a year ago, with late vessels arriving 6.81 days behind schedule on average. Xeneta measures 29%, down 4 pp. The 20.9 pp gap is methodology, not error: Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time within one day of schedule, while Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day. Both put Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd first and second. For planning, assume roughly half of arrivals will miss their scheduled day and leave slack in delivery promises.

Global on-time share



Carriers: same month, two methods



CARRIER	SEA-INTELLIGENCE AUG 2026	RANK	XENETA AUG 2026	RANK	GAP
Maersk	67.3%	1	51%	1	+16.3 pp
Hapag-Lloyd	61.5%	2	46%	2	+15.5 pp
MSC	55.2%	3	24%	6	+31.2 pp
CMA CGM	50.6%	4	33%	3	+17.6 pp
ZIM	43.8%	5	31%	4	+12.8 pp
COSCO	43.2%	6	22%	7	+21.2 pp
ONE	42.8%	7	29%	5	+13.8 pp
OOCL	41.5%	8	–		
Yang Ming	40.1%	9	6%	12	+34.1 pp
HMM	39.3%	10	9%	11	+30.3 pp
Evergreen	36.4%	11	20%	8	+16.4 pp
PIL	32.0%	12	10%	9	+22.0 pp
Wan Hai	23.2%	13	9%	10	+14.2 pp

Sea-Intelligence: Share of vessel arrivals within one day of scheduled arrival; 34 trade lanes, 60+ carriers (GLP report). Average delay for late arrivals 6.81 days.

Xeneta: Share of vessel arrivals on the scheduled day (eeSea data); Xeneta Ocean Benchmark. Xeneta ranks 12 carriers (OOCL is not listed separately).

Gap = Sea-Intelligence minus Xeneta, percentage points. Different definitions of 'on time' and different vessel samples; the gap is expected and is itself informative.

PORT & CARRIER NOTICES · PAST SEVEN DAYS

Advisories

Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd plan to resume Suez Canal routing on the AE12 service from 27 October, and Hapag-Lloyd is reported to be restoring Suez transits on its India to US East Coast service. Surcharges keep building: Maersk peak season surcharges on South America to Europe (USD 500) and Europe to South Africa, a CMA CGM reefer surcharge from South America to North Europe, and new FAK rates from MSC and CMA CGM. Peel Ports has reinstated a weekly Greenock to Rotterdam service.

Ports

NEW Peel Ports reinstates weekly Greenock-Rotterdam container service · Port of Liverpool (Peel Ports) · 2026-09-24 · Container Management

Carriers

NEW Maersk implements USD 500 peak season surcharge on South America-Europe routes · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · Data Portuaria

NEW Maersk implements peak season surcharge on Europe-South Africa route · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · Data Portuaria

NEW MSC announces new Far East to Europe FAK rates · MSC · 2026-09-29 · container-news.com

NEW Hapag-Lloyd to resume Suez transits for India-USEC service: sources · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-30 · Journal of Commerce

NEW Maersk, Hapag-Lloyd to resume Suez Canal routing for AE12 service from 27 October - Urban & Transport - Egypt · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-29 · Ahram Online

NEW CMA CGM raises Asia–Mediterranean FAK rates · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · container-news.com

NEW CMA CGM adds reefer surcharge from South America to North Europe · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · container-news.com

Sources, method & data health

Weather is treated as a leading indicator: flags mark days when forecast wind or sea state reach levels at which crane work or pilot boarding is commonly suspended, or heavy weather slows transits. They are probabilistic signals, not port notices; always confirm with your terminal or carrier.

Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0).

Data health this run: marine weather **ok** · cyclones **ok** · sinay congestion **skipped** · schedule reliability **ok** · advisories **ok**.